

Muncie Redevelopment Commission Meeting October 17th 2024

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LvbZIWHEkE
Publication Date	2024-10-18T02:08:02Z
Target Category	muncie_city

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Meeting Summary Report

Meeting: Muncie Redevelopment Commission (MRC) Regular Meeting

Date: October 17, 2024

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer opened the meeting at **00:00:22**, officially welcoming attendees to the October 17, 2024 Muncie Redevelopment Commission meeting.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Bishop, Mr. Dale, Mr. Miller, Mr. Pilla, and Ms. Wagley.
 - **Members Absent:** None.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly named in the transcript introduction, but leading the proceedings.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Not present in the transcript.
- **Approval of Agenda:**

- *Deliberation:* Commissioners discussed adding a legal counsel update regarding statutory changes to the agenda.
 - *Action & Vote:* Accepted and approved as presented by voice vote [00:01:12](#).
 - **Approval of Previous Meeting Minutes:**
 - *Deliberation:* Mr. Dale noted concerns that the minutes continue to misstate topics discussed and formative discussions, stating he would vote against approval. Ms. Wagley moved to approve.
 - *Action & Vote:* Approved 4-1 (Mr. Dale voted “no”) [00:01:59](#).
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3. Substantive Business & Board Action

[00:02:15](#) Claims Review & Approval

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Craig Wright.
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Highlighted a \$1 million claim for the TWG Kilgore Place project and noted the MRC annual pledge installment for the Muncie Land Bank.
 - Commissioners discussed utility payments for the Y property following its July 11 closing, noting that future billings should be the developer’s responsibility.
 - Commissioners inquired about an MRC bond paving invoice (758) regarding IMI surfacing on Highland Avenue (Granville to Elm). Mr. Wright explained that unexpected railroad ties were uncovered beneath the road during removal, requiring extra removal and resurfacing work.
- **Action & Vote:** Claims approved by unanimous voice vote [00:06:16](#).

[00:17:32](#) Omnibus Property Transfers to the City of Muncie

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jeff How (City administration).
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Administration proposed transferring three MRC-owned properties to the City of Muncie to streamline responsibilities:
 1. **Store Estates Park** (to be maintained by the Parks Department).
 2. **901 West Rigan Road** (utilized by Animal Control/Shelter).
 3. **2000 Block of North Granville** (utilized by the Muncie Police Department for training).
 - Commissioners discussed ensuring formal agreements protect current organizational users (such as the animal shelter) and agreeing to treat all transfers uniformly under the City Corporation’s name.
- **Action & Vote:** Motion to transfer all three properties to the City Corporation approved by unanimous voice vote [00:23:10](#).

00:23:32 Property Purchase Application: 2800 South Franklin Street

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jeff How / Deborah and Dale Bailey.
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Applicants Deborah and Dale Bailey applied to purchase 2800 South Franklin Street to store car trailers.
 - Zoning concerns were raised: the parcel is zoned residential, meaning storage of trailers would require a zoning variance. Staff noted that applicants typically cannot apply for a variance until they own the property.
 - Applicants and commissioners also raised concerns about hazardous mature trees threatening a newly purchased neighboring house.
 - Mr. Pilla expressed opposition to turning a vacant residential lot into a fenced trailer/car storage area.
 - **Action & Vote:** Tabled to allow the applicants to work with city staff on zoning steps and property assessment. Approved by voice vote **00:32:04**.
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4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:51:13 Mr. Caner (FC Tucker Real Estate):** Spoke regarding opportunities for a boutique hotel, mentioning a 51-unit retrofit opportunity on Main Street and noting that the Village Inn is under contract with a 3-way liquor license available. Encouraged the city and MRC to coordinate more closely with local commercial brokers regarding unlisted city-controlled properties.
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5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff & Board Reports:**
 - **City Report (00:06:32):** Jeff How provided financial updates (Focus funds totaling \$2.6M, cash funds, and an estimated consolidated Tiff fund of \$2.2M by year-end). Provided project updates on Store Estates Park ribbon cutting, Westside Park skate park (awarded to Flat Land by Board of Works), YWCA property development interest, a potential downtown boutique hotel feasibility study, housing projects, and early discussions on declining neighborhood incentive programs.
 - **Legal Update (00:32:38):** Ben Freeman reviewed 2024 legislative changes impacting Redevelopment Commissions, including school corporation approval eliminations for housing allocation areas, economic development target area changes for counties, the 1% test elimination, reduced maximum terms for residential housing programs (20 years), the mandatory annual spending plan due December 1st, annual reporting requirements, and upcoming live streaming mandates starting July 1, 2025.

- **Land Bank Update (00:44:16):** Nate Howard reported the sale of a business-zoned property for a hot pepper farm, 38 out of 40 awarded properties clearing the redemption process (moving toward deed petitions), preparations for the upcoming November 19 tax sale (approx. 850 properties), receipt of a full Ball Brothers Foundation grant, and staff attendance at a vacant properties conference in St. Louis.
 - **Sidewalk Update (00:52:57):** Jeff How clarified that downtown sidewalk work is proceeding with curbs and ADA requirements, while portions affected by Main and Jackson state highway work are awaiting state schedules.
 - **Adjournment:**
 - The meeting was officially adjourned by voice vote 00:43:33.
 - **Next Meeting Date:** November 21, 2024.
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